



Product Teardown

5 sharpest feedbacks

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The one-liner

The technology looks strong: 99.9% uptime, sub-300ms, multi-model routing.

But a brand-new user cannot actually use it. Activation is broken before value is ever seen.

So I didn't just review the website. I signed up, tried to build an agent and make a call, and *that journey* is the teardown.

5 feedbacks, prioritized

#	Pillar	Feedback	Sev
1	Features / Activation	New users hit " Feature Locked " on the agent builder; core loop unreachable	Crit
2	GTM / Pricing	/pricing 404s , yet a real ₹1 = 1 credit model lives in-app; two paywalls	Crit
3	Competition	"India-first" asserted, unquantified and out-gunned by Sarvam/Gnani/Smallest	High
4	UX	Post-login is 14-item nav overload plus passkey nag , not guidance	Med
5	Collaborations	Real distribution (n8n, Chrome ext) buried; India AI stack unused	Med

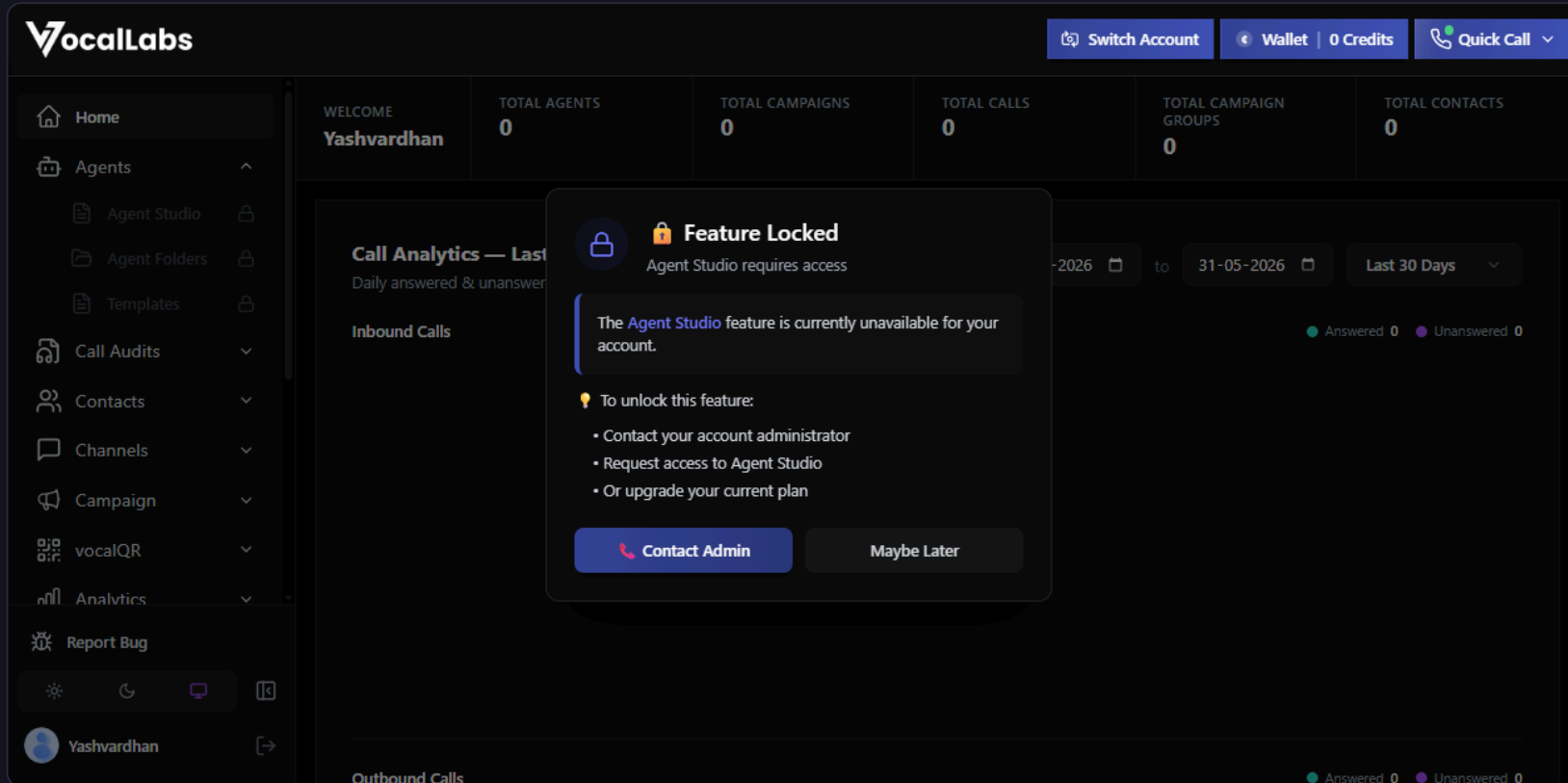
One feedback per pillar, deliberately not all in one area. #1 and #2 are both Critical: together they are why the first mile is broken.

1 · A new user can't build an agent **CRITICAL**

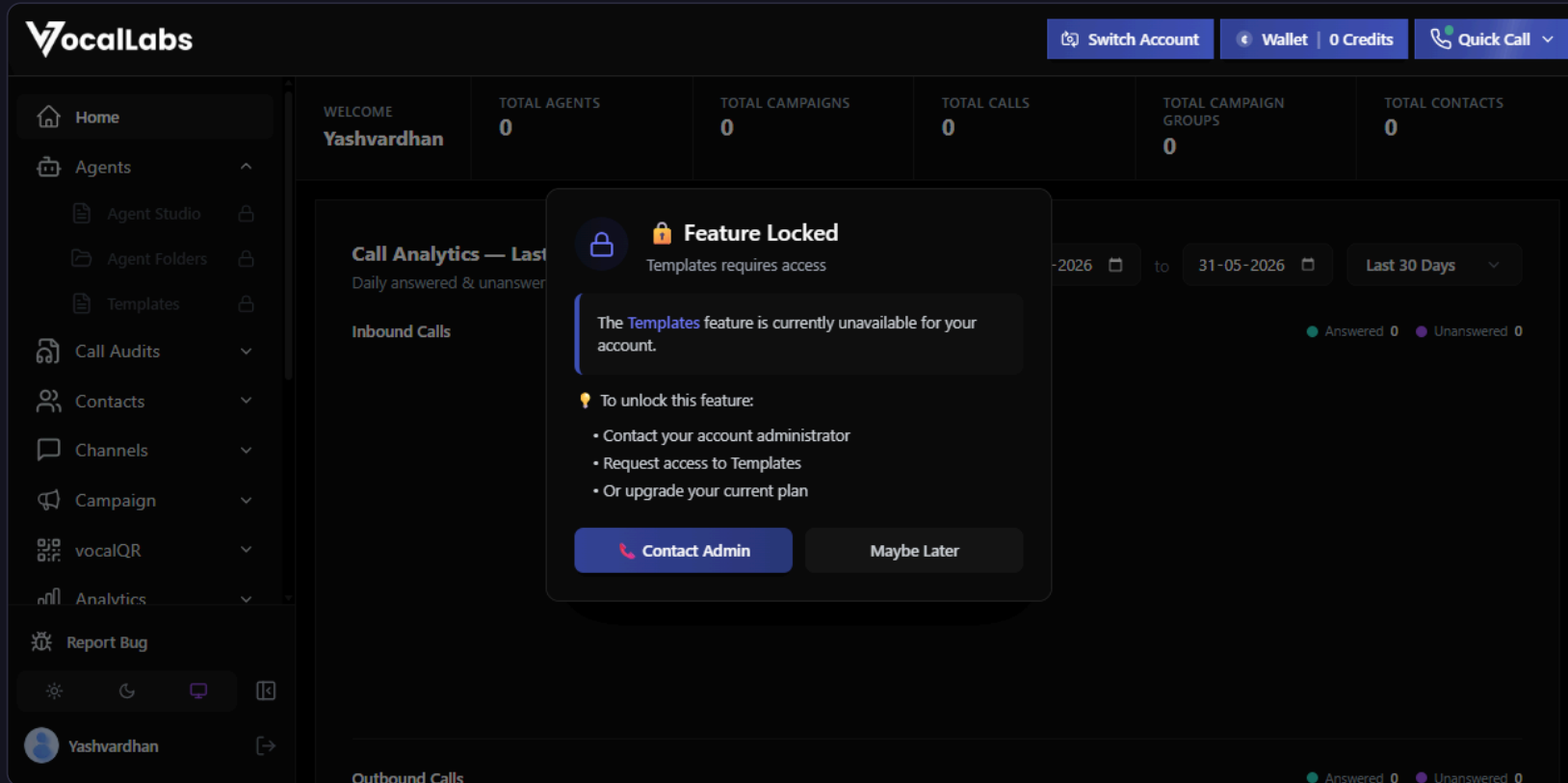
OBSERVED: Sign up, try to build (**locked**), try a template (**locked**), try to call (needs an agent you can't make): **dead end**.

Pillar: Features / Services · Severity: Critical · Effort: Medium

Agent Studio: "Feature Locked"



Templates: also locked



Quick Call needs an agent that can't exist

Make a Call

Initiate AI Call
Select an agent and enter the phone number to start

Select AI Agent * Production Only ☐

All Agents Talk to Agent

Phone Number *

Enter phone number or search contacts

Enter phone number with country code (e.g., 919876543210)

Make Call **Cancel** **Chat**

Agent dropdown shows only an "All Agents" placeholder; TOTAL AGENTS: 0, and none can be created.

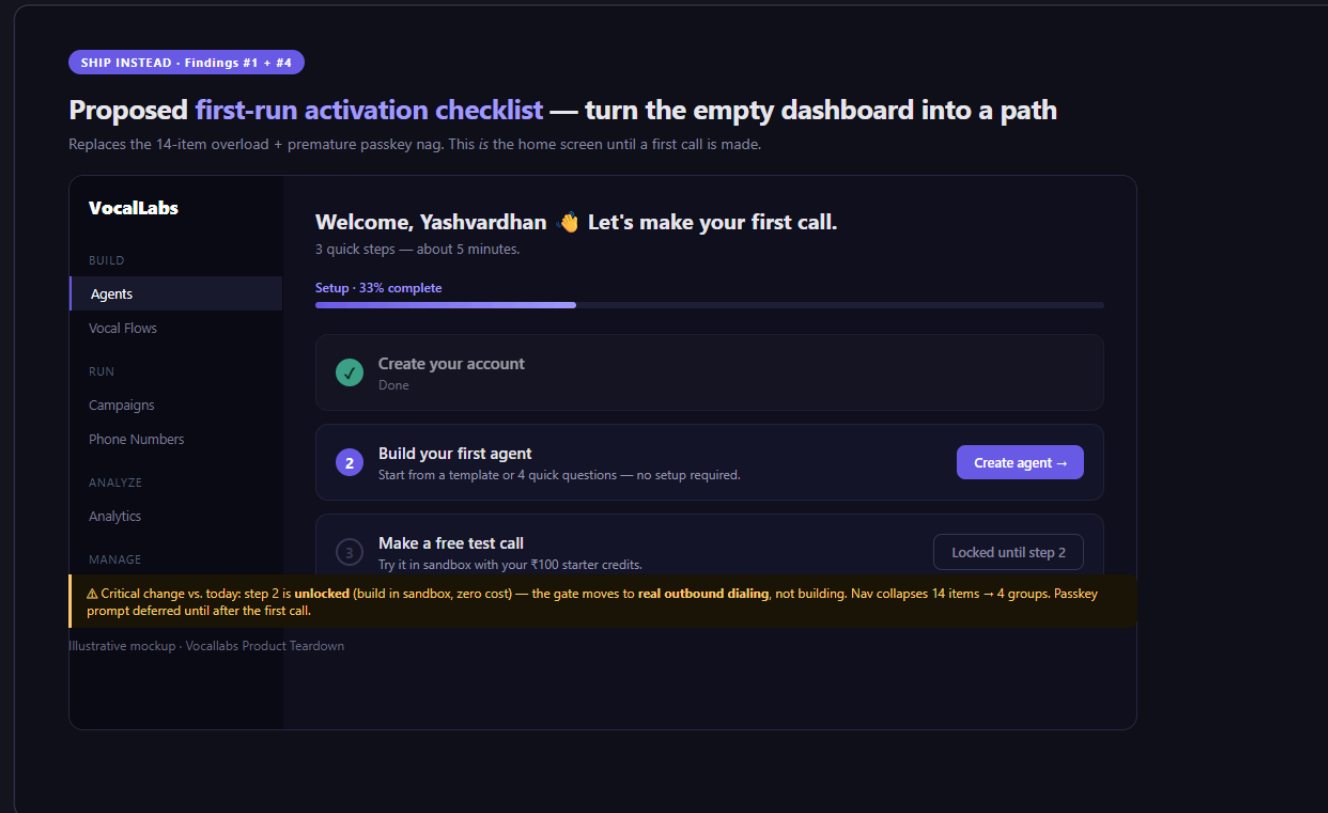
Why it matters and what to ship

PROBLEM: Time-to-first-value is **infinite** for self-serve. Contradicts the SDK/n8n/Chrome-ext PLG strategy. Retell gives \$10 free credits; Smallest builds an agent in 5 min, so devs activate there instead.

SHIP INSTEAD: Ungate creation, gate consumption. Let anyone build and test in sandbox; require credits only to dial real outbound. The current "Contact Admin" button is a dead-end for a self-serve user who has no admin.

Tradeoff: gating is likely intentional (cost/abuse), but it's in the wrong place. Block *dialing*, not *building*.

Ship instead: a first-run activation flow (fixes #1 and #4)



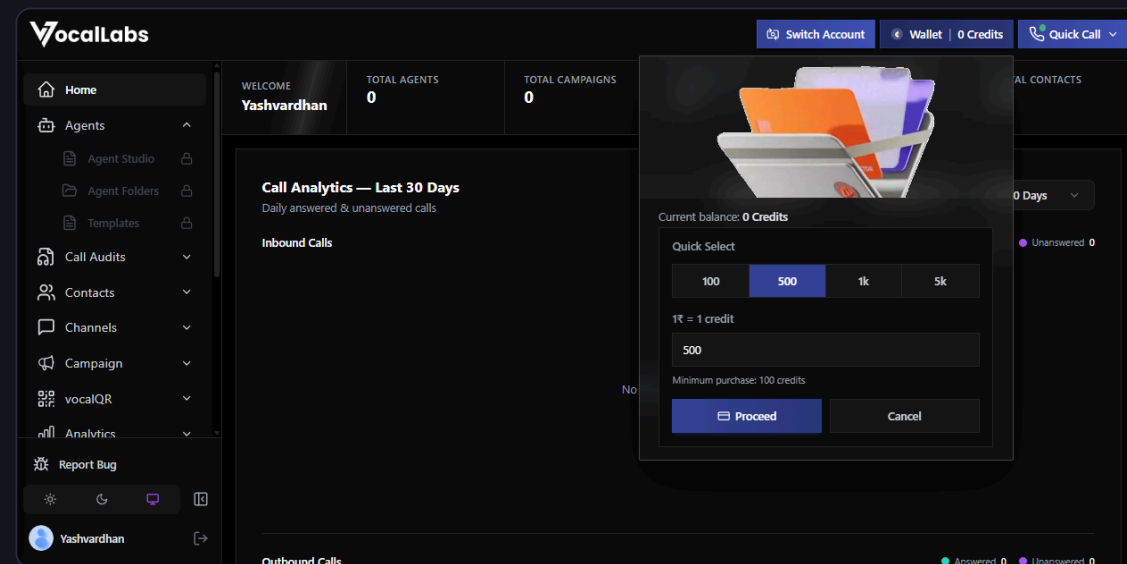
2 · Price is a 404 on web, a credit model in-app **CRITICAL**

Pillar: GTM / Pricing · Severity: Critical · Effort: Low (highest ROI per effort)

/pricing returns 404

But in-app: ₹1 = 1 credit

404 | This page could not be found.



Why it matters and what to ship

PROBLEM: Self-serve buyers can't qualify themselves; rivals publish per-minute rates. The lock copy implies **two paywalls** (credits = usage, "plan access" = features), so credits alone likely won't unlock the builder (inferred from copy, not purchased).

SHIP INSTEAD: Publish the pricing that already exists, including the credits-per-minute burn that even a logged-in user can't currently compute. Add a calculator. Give free starter credits (like Retell's \$10).

Ship instead: the **/pricing** page that replaces the 404

SHIP INSTEAD - Finding #2

Proposed **/pricing** page — publish the credit model that already exists in-app

Replaces today's 404. Surfaces the ₹1 = 1 credit model, separates the two paywalls, and lets buyers self-qualify in seconds.

FREE TRIAL

₹0

Build & test before you pay — fixes the activation dead-end.

- ✓ Create + test agents in sandbox
- ✓ ₹100 free starter credits
- ✓ 1 phone number

Start free

PAY-AS-YOU-GO

₹1

= 1 credit

Prepaid credits in ₹. No USD card. Min top-up ₹100.

- ✓ ≈ X credits / minute of call
- ✓ All builder features unlocked
- ✓ n8n, SDK & Chrome extension

Top up credits

ENTERPRISE

Custom

Volume rates, dedicated infra, voice biometrics, SLA.

- ✓ Committed-use discounts
- ✓ Bhashini / on-prem options
- ✓ Priority support + onboarding

Talk to sales

△ Key fix: today there are **two hidden paywalls** — credits (usage) AND a separate "plan access" gate on the builder. This page states both plainly: **credits = how much you talk** • **plan = what you can build**.

Illustrative mockup — credit-per-minute rate (X) to be filled from real telephony cost · Vocallabs Product Teardown

3 · "India-first" is asserted, not proven HIGH

OBSERVED: The homepage leads with generic infra ("Sub-300ms", "Any Protocol. One API") and **never quantifies** the India-first moat, with **no clear ICP** (dev, SMB, enterprise messaging are mixed).

PROBLEM: On paper a buyer sees **Sarvam** (22 langs, govt-backed), **Gnani** (40+/12 Indic, 30M daily calls), **Smallest** (under 100ms), and Vocallabs loses a comparison it should win.

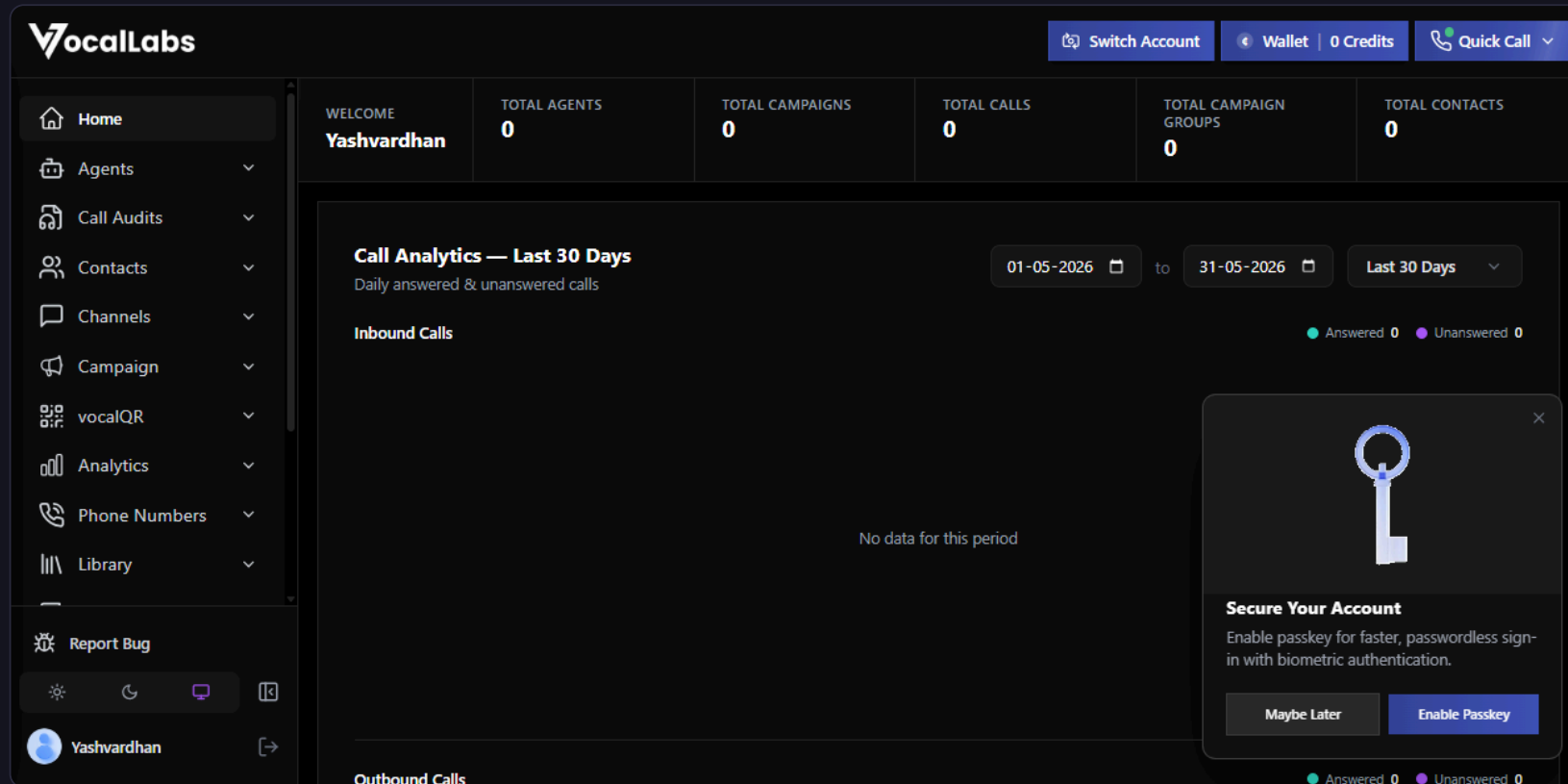
SHIP INSTEAD: **Quantify the moat** with a 30-sec code-mixed audio demo, and **name one ICP**: collections/BFSI (Skit-style, self-serve) or SMBs the enterprise players ignore.

4 · Login succeeds, then overload, not onboarding

MED

OBSERVED: 14 nav items (about 10 above the fold, rest below); three overlapping agent surfaces (Agent Studio vs Vocal Flows vs Templates); opaque names (vocalQR, EazyReach); a passkey nag **before any value**; no first-run guide.

The empty dashboard a new user lands on



Why it matters and what to ship

PROBLEM: Compounds #1: maximum cognitive load at the exact moment the user is already stuck behind a locked builder. Reads as an internal power-tool, not a self-serve product.

SHIP INSTEAD: First-run checklist as the home screen until done. Group 14 items into Build / Run / Analyze / Manage. Defer passkey.

5 · Distribution assets buried, India stack unused MED

OBSERVED: An **n8n node** (per product brief; GitHub org: Vocallabsai) and a **Chrome extension** exist but aren't used as growth channels. No Zapier/Make. **Bhashini / Sarvam / AI4Bharat** unused.

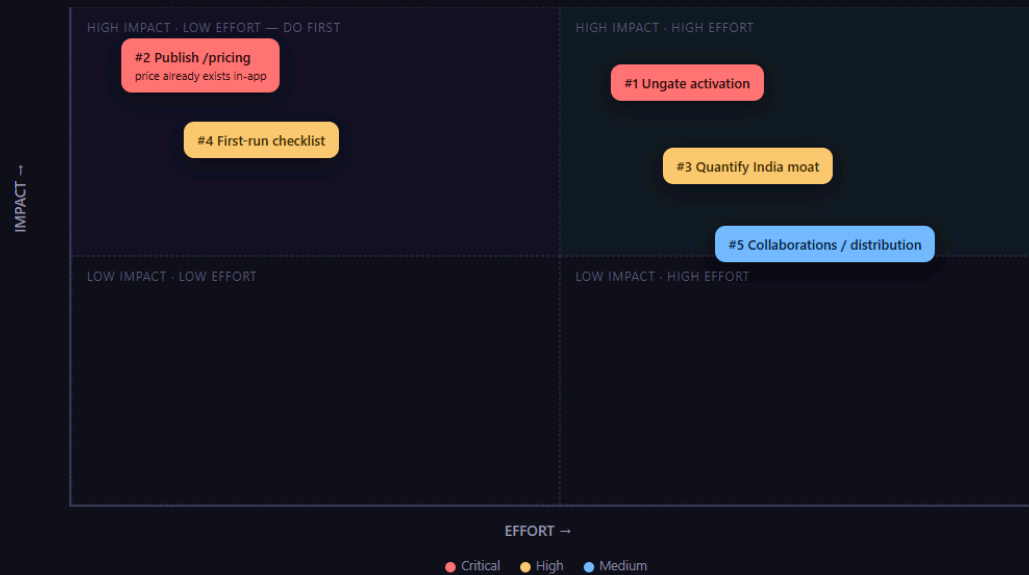
PROBLEM: A PLG product with no working self-serve activation *and* no leveraged distribution has no growth engine.

SHIP INSTEAD: Get the n8n node **verified** and publish template workflows. **Integrate Bhashini** to unlock gov/BFSI procurement, then a channel play for the collections wedge.

Prioritization

Prioritization — impact × effort

Sequenced by "does it block value from being experienced at all?" Top-left = do first (high impact, low effort).



Day-1 plan

Sequenced by "**does it block value from being experienced at all?**" then effort.

When	Ship
30 days	Publish /pricing (#2) · ungate sandbox agent and 1 template (#1) · first-run checklist (#4)
60 days	Instrument activation funnel and move first-agent rate · quantified India-first page plus audio demo (#3)
90 days	Verified n8n listing and workflows plus Bhashini spike (#5) · pick one wedge vertical

"Whoever joins owns and executes these from Day 1." I'd start with the ₹0-cost, highest-leverage one: publish the price that already exists.



Thank you

Net: **strong tech, broken first-mile**. Fix activation and price transparency, and the rest of the funnel finally gets a chance to work.

Full report: `VOCALLABS_PRODUCT_TEARDOWN.md` · evidence in `screenshots/` · research in `research/`